Analyzing the Role of Key Stakeholders in the July Uprising 2024 in Bangladesh: Actors and Factors Approach

Sumaiya Fahmida Shifa

ID: 23-50138-1 Section:C

BSc in Computer Science and Engineering (CSE)

American International University of Bangladesh

Abstract

The July Uprising of 2024 is examined as a pivotal moment in Bangladesh's democratic trajectory that ultimately resulted in the collapse of the 16-year Awami League regime. Ongoing debates persist regarding the ownership of the movement and the relative contributions of different groups. Central to this discussion is the identification of key actors and the factors that shaped their roles during the uprising. This study analyzes the actors, driving factors, and interrelationships involved in the July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh using a mixed-method approach, including literature reviews and convenience surveys (n = 87). Guided by stakeholder theory, eleven key actors are identified: the Awami League government; the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement; Bangladesh Student League; YouTubers/bloggers; the general public; media; international community/NGOs; opposition political parties (BNP, Jamaat-e-Islami, etc.); law and security enforcement agencies (RAB, Police, BGB, Bangladesh Army, etc.); the Supreme Court; and university authorities. Findings indicate that the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement and the general public exhibited high power and interest, whereas the Awami League government and university authorities retained significant power but demonstrated low interest. Correlation analysis reveals a positive relationship between the interests of the general public and student protestors ($r = 0.44$), a moderate correlation between media influence and government power ($r = 0.25$), and a negative correlation between the power of law enforcement agencies and student protestors ($r = -0.25$). The study underscores the necessity of inclusive governance and sustained political dialogue to address structural grievances and strengthen democratic values.

Introduction

The July uprising, also known as the Bangladesh 2.0 movement, is a notable instance of anti-discrimination and pro-democracy protests that were primarily started by the students of Dhaka University (Chughtai & Ali, 2024). The movement's initial goal was to change the quota-based system from the government recruitment, especially in light of the Supreme Court's verdict to reinstate a 30% quota for descendants of freedom fighters. This ruling overruled an earlier government decision of cancelling all quota systems from the government job that was the result of the 2018 quota reform movement (Islam et. al., 2024). Students felt that their merit-based opportunities were becoming limited, and this reinstatement created a great deal of unhappiness among them. Besides, 16 years of division based on political ideology fueled the sentiment of the people which resulted into a widespread protests by the students all over the Bangladesh. After the violent clashes and attacks, the situation spiraled out of control, leading to the July massacre, which took many lives. In addition to using firearms and sharp weapons, activities in that time included the shutdown of educational institutions, the mobilization of the party activists and the law enforcement agencies against each-other. The government effectively cut off Bangladesh from international contacts by enacting a nationwide shoot-at-sight curfew and a complete blackout of cell and internet connectivity in reaction to the growing discontent (Roy, 2024). As of August 2, there had been over thousands of injuries and arrests, and 266 verified deaths. UNICEF has recorded the deaths of at least 32 children during the riots (Mishra, 2024). The government's restrictions on hospitals' ability to communicate with the media, the seizure of hospital security footage, and the secret burial of numerous victims of gunshot wounds made it more difficult to determine the precise death toll. Awami League government claimed that other political groups had appropriated the protests for their own purposes. Curfews were enforced, but the movement continued and expanded its demands, calling for responsibility for state violence, banning the student politics, and the resignation of important government figures. In the end, the widespread violence against civilians turned the student-led demonstrations into a larger movement of non-cooperation, which reflected a larger social revolt against the government and as a result, ex-Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina resigned and flew to India (Bangladesh: Prime Minister Hasina resign, 2024).To date, much scholarly attention has been devoted to analyzing the impacts and historical context of the July uprising; however, our research will focus specifically on the actors and relevant factors involved in this movement. We aim to explore the various actors, including government entities, student organizations, anti-discrimination movement platform, and international organizations or Non-Government Organizations (NGO), etc. while examining their interrelations and the dynamics of power and interests at play. Initially, we will elucidate the significance of the movement within the broader socio-political landscape, followed by a comprehensive examination of its background. This analysis will extend to understanding how the initial nine-point agenda of the movement coalesced into a singular focus, propelled by the concerted efforts of diverse actors. Subsequently, we will delve into

the specific power structures and interests of each actor by assessing how these factors influenced their actions and decisions throughout the uprising. Finally, we will provide strategic recommendations for political parties on navigating complex social movements and addressing the concerns of different actors effectively with the understanding of the correlation coefficient (r) matrix of different actors.

Methodology

A mixed-methods approach was adopted to examine the actors involved in the July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh, integrating qualitative and quantitative techniques (Bryman, 2012; Creswell & Plano Clark, 2011). An extensive review of secondary literature was first conducted to contextualize the uprising and identify key actors. Subsequently, convenience surveys using a closed-ended questionnaire were administered to assess public perceptions of the power and interest of 11 identified actors, including the Awami League government, Anti-Discrimination Students Movement, Bangladesh Student League, media, law enforcement agencies (RAB, Police, BGB, etc.), YouTubers/bloggers, the general public, international community/NGOs, opposition political parties (BNP, Jamaat-e-Islami, etc.), the Supreme Court, and university authorities.

Survey responses from 87 participants (n = 87) were analyzed using Excel and SPSS to calculate mean power and interest scores for each actor. The sample included 45 males and 42 females, comprising students, protesters, teachers, and political activists. A stakeholder matrix was constructed to classify actors into four categories based on power and interest levels. In addition, a correlation matrix analysis was conducted to examine the direction and strength of relationships among actors. This methodological approach enabled a structured assessment of actor dynamics during the uprising.

Literature Review

The July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh has been widely viewed as a collective response to prolonged political repression, corruption, and human rights violations under the Awami League government. The immediate catalyst was the Supreme Court's reinstatement of a quota system in government employment favoring descendants of liberation fighters, which was broadly perceived as discriminatory. Rising youth unemployment, economic pressure, and restricted access to merit-based opportunities intensified dissatisfaction, particularly among students (Gupta, 2024). Reports by the International Labour Organization indicated increasing youth participation in the labor force alongside limited employment opportunities, further exacerbating grievances. Violent crackdowns by security forces escalated tensions, transforming demands for quota reform into a broader call for democracy, justice, and political accountability, including the resignation of Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina (Prakash, 2024).The uprising has been analyzed through established social movement theories. Relative Deprivation Theory (Gurr, 2011) explains the mobilization as a response to the gap between expectations of merit-based advancement and the reality of quota-based exclusion. Resource Mobilization Theory (McCarthy & Zald, 1977) highlights the role of social media, university networks, and organizational resources in enabling rapid coordination and nationwide protest.State repression theories further explain the escalation of the movement. According to Tilly (1978), increased state violence often intensifies resistance, a pattern reflected in the transformation of student protests into a mass uprising following police and Chhatra League violence. Davenport's theory of coercive state violence (2007) similarly suggests that tactics such as paramilitary deployment, internet blackouts, and shoot-at-sight curfews may suppress dissent temporarily but often provoke broader opposition.Political Opportunity Theory (Tarrow, 1998) identifies the Supreme Court ruling as a critical opening for mobilization, while Framing Theory (Snow & Benford, 1988) explains how the quota issue was reframed as resistance to authoritarianism, expanding support beyond students. International norm dynamics theory (Finnemore & Sikkink, 1998) further contextualizes the movement, as condemnation by international organizations increased external pressure on the government.

Finally, theories of hybrid regimes and democratic backsliding (Levitsky & Way, 2010) and Economic Protest Theory (Kriesi, 1995) situate the uprising within broader patterns of authoritarian governance, economic grievance, and mass mobilization. To systematically analyze actor influence within this context, stakeholder matrix analysis is applied to assess power–interest relationships among key participants (Frooman, 1999).

Data Presentation

Context: Sixteen Years of Awami League Rule

The July Uprising of 2024 is widely regarded as the outcome of prolonged political repression, economic hardship, and democratic erosion during the 16-year rule of the Awami League under Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina. The period was marked by deep political polarization, pervasive corruption, and a narrowing of democratic space, which collectively generated widespread public discontent (Rishi, 2024). Political control was reinforced through the promotion of a "Freedom Fighters versus Others" narrative, which framed opposition groups as anti-national and

intensified exclusion and mistrust within the political system (Haque, 2024). Consequently, opposition parties—particularly the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and Jamaat-e-Islami—were systematically marginalized.

Democratic institutions were further weakened through disputed national elections in 2014, 2018, and 2024, which were characterized by allegations of voter intimidation, manipulation, and suppression, alongside repeated opposition boycotts (Siddiqui & Paul, 2019). These electoral practices contributed to widespread perceptions of disenfranchisement and the collapse of electoral credibility.

At the same time, civic and political spaces were increasingly constrained. Independent media, civil society organizations, and dissenting voices were subjected to censorship, harassment, and legal persecution, allowing state authority to be consolidated with limited accountability (The State of Media Freedom in Bangladesh, 2021). Although periods of economic growth were recorded, structural economic problems—including inequality, corruption, rising living costs, and post-pandemic pressures—persisted. High-profile governance failures and corruption scandals further eroded public trust (Taylor, 2016; Mustafa, 2024).

Youth dissatisfaction intensified amid limited employment opportunities and restricted political participation. Despite earlier political disengagement, students emerged as leading actors in 2024, mobilized primarily by opposition to discriminatory job quotas favoring descendants of liberation fighters. Ultimately, prolonged repression, economic strain, and institutional decay converged to produce the July Uprising, representing a critical turning point in Bangladesh's political history, with its long-term democratic outcomes remaining uncertain.

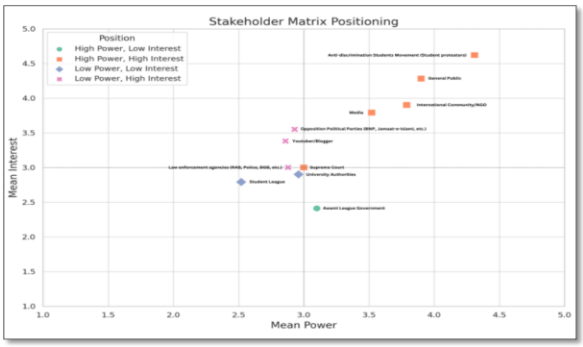
Discrimination in Politics and Society During the Awami League Regime

From 2008 to 2024, Bangladesh's political and social environment was shaped by systemic favoritism and exclusion under the Awami League government. Public-sector recruitment was widely perceived as politicized, particularly through the civil service quota system that reserved 30 percent of positions for descendants of liberation fighters. Although justified as historical recognition, the policy was criticized for privileging political affiliation over merit and undermining institutional credibility (Corea & Erum, 2024). The marginalization of qualified candidates contributed to widespread dissatisfaction and fueled the quota reform movement led primarily by students and young people.Discriminatory practices were also reported in post-examination recruitment processes, where successful Bangladesh Civil Service candidates were denied appointments due to politically influenced police verification procedures. In parallel, dissent was suppressed through legal mechanisms such as the Digital Security Act and the ICT Act, which were used to detain journalists, activists, and critics of the government, fostering a climate of fear and restricting freedom of expression (Almond, 2019).Public trust was further eroded by pervasive corruption, particularly in the banking sector, where large-scale embezzlement involving individuals linked to the ruling party was reported. Allegations of corruption within the Election Commission also weakened confidence in democratic governance. Collectively, political discrimination, repression of dissent, and institutional corruption generated widespread frustration and contributed to the mass protests of July–August 2024, marking a decisive rupture in Bangladesh's political landscape.

July Uprising 2024 and Its Aftermath

The July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh was the result of prolonged political repression, economic exclusion, and institutional corruption under the Awami League government, which had ruled for more than 16 years. Democratic norms were progressively weakened through restrictions on press freedom, limitations on free expression, and the use of law enforcement agencies to suppress dissent. These practices generated widespread resentment, particularly among young people who experienced political marginalization and limited economic opportunity.Despite sustained economic growth, employment opportunities remained constrained, especially for educated youth. Although Bangladesh was frequently cited as a high-growth economy, the benefits were unevenly distributed, leaving an estimated 2.6 million young people unemployed (Zaman, 2024). This disconnect between economic performance and lived realities intensified public dissatisfaction. Public trust was further eroded by persistent allegations of corruption, reflected in Bangladesh's low ranking in Transparency International's 2023 Corruption Perception Index.The reinstatement of the government job quota system served as the immediate catalyst for mass mobilization. Under this system, 56 percent of public-sector positions were reserved, including 30 percent for descendants of liberation fighters (Ganguly, 2024). Although originally intended to address historical inequalities, the policy was increasingly perceived as discriminatory and incompatible with merit-based recruitment. The High Court's decision in June 2024 to reinstate the quota system triggered widespread student protests.Demonstrations began at Dhaka University on July 1, 2024, and rapidly expanded nationwide. Initial demands

centered on quota reform; however, the movement escalated following violent state responses, including inflammatory rhetoric, the mobilization of party-affiliated



groups, and the use of force by security agencies. Student deaths, notably that of Abu Sayeed in Rangpur, intensified public outrage and transformed the protests into a broader anti-authoritarian movement.As curfews were imposed and communication networks disrupted, the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement expanded its demands to include accountability for state violence, the banning of the Bangladesh Chhatra League, and the resignation of senior officials. The uprising ultimately evolved into a nationwide non-cooperation movement, culminating in the resignation of Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina. The events of July 2024 underscored the capacity of youth-led mobilization to challenge entrenched political power and reaffirmed the central importance of democratic accountability and social justice.

Reform to Revolution: From Nine-Point to One-Point Demand

The July Uprising of 2024 was led by the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement and initially focused on reforming the government job quota system. The quota policy was widely viewed as unfair and harmful to merit-based recruitment. Students demanded the cancellation of the existing quota system and the introduction of limited and fair quotas for marginalized groups.After the Supreme Court reinstated a 30 percent quota for descendants of liberation fighters, student protests spread rapidly across universities. The movement escalated sharply when protests were met with violence by law enforcement agencies and the ruling party's student wing, the Bangladesh Chhatra League. Student deaths and injuries marked a turning point and led to an expansion of demands.A nine-point demand was later announced, calling for a public apology from the Prime Minister, the resignation of responsible ministers, punishment of police officials involved in violence, the resignation of university authorities, and a ban on the Bangladesh Chhatra League in educational institutions. These demands shifted the movement from quota reform to accountability for state violence.As repression continued, the movement adopted a non-cooperation strategy and consolidated its demands into a single point: the resignation of Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina and her cabinet. This shift marked the transformation of the movement from reform-oriented protest to a broader revolutionary struggle for democratic accountability.

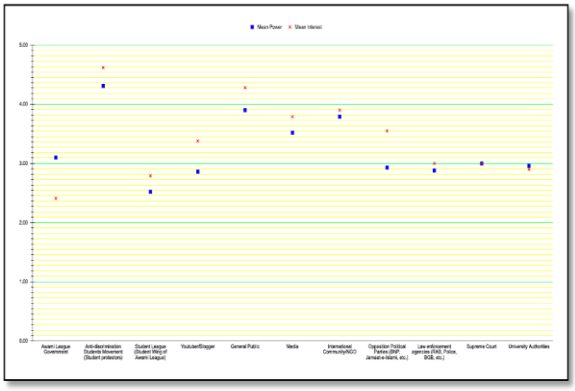
Opposition Parties (BNP, Jamaat-e-Islami, etc.)

The Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and Jamaat-e-Islami were indirectly involved in the July Uprising following prolonged political repression under the Awami League government. Over the previous 16 years, party leaders and activists—particularly from Jamaat-e-Islami—were subjected to arrests, trials, executions, and systematic suppression, which fostered long-term resentment and organizational resilience.During the uprising, experienced activists from both parties contributed to sustaining mobilization, largely at the grassroots level. Individuals associated with Islami Chhatra Shibir were involved in coordination and organizational support behind the scenes. BNP maintained a strategic distance by allowing student groups to lead publicly, thereby reducing the risk of intensified state repression and preserving the movement's legitimacy.Although the uprising appeared student-led, the background support, experience, and strategic restraint of BNP and Jamaat-e-Islami played a significant role in maintaining momentum and continuity.

Power and Interest Rating of Key Actors

The power–interest analysis (Figure 2) illustrates variations in influence and engagement among key actors during the July Uprising. The Awami League government displayed relatively high power (3.10) but low interest (2.41), indicating limited responsiveness to public and student demands. Violent repression and dismissive rhetoric reflected this disengagement and contributed to protest escalation.In contrast, the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement demonstrated the highest levels of power (4.31) and interest (4.62), reflecting strong mobilization capacity, nationwide coordination, and sustained commitment. The general public also showed high power (3.90) and interest (4.28), particularly as state violence intensified and the movement evolved into a broader struggle for democratic rights.Media actors recorded moderately high power (3.52) and interest (3.79), though their influence was constrained

by censorship and intimidation. YouTubers and bloggers exhibited moderate power (2.86) and interest (3.38),



primarily through online narrative framing. The international community and NGOs demonstrated

relatively high power (3.79) and interest (3.90), as external pressure and human rights advocacy intensified. Opposition political parties showed moderate power (2.93) and interest (3.55), reflecting indirect and strategic involvement. Law enforcement agencies exhibited moderate power (2.88) and low interest (3.00), with their role focused on enforcement rather than engagement. A negative correlation between the power of law enforcement agencies and student protestors ($r = -0.25$) highlights the adversarial relationship between the state and the movement.

Key Actors and Their Roles in the July Uprising

During the July Uprising of 2024, multiple actors with varying levels of power and interest shaped the course of events. The Awami League government, despite possessing high institutional power, demonstrated low interest in addressing protest demands and relied primarily on repression, deploying police, RAB, and BGB to suppress demonstrations, which resulted in extensive casualties and public outrage. The Bangladesh Student League, aligned with the ruling party, opposed the movement through violent actions against student protestors, triggering nationwide student resistance. Law enforcement agencies acted largely as instruments of state control, employing force against protestors, while their actions intensified public anger and contributed to the escalation of the uprising. The Supreme Court played a pivotal role by reinstating the controversial quota system, which was widely perceived as undermining meritocracy and served as a direct catalyst for mass mobilization. In contrast, the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement emerged as the central driving force, exhibiting high power and high interest through coordinated nationwide protests led by student and youth organizers. University authorities largely remained disengaged or acted to contain protests, whereas sections of university teachers actively supported student safety and demands. The general public became a powerful stakeholder as outrage over state violence led to widespread participation beyond student circles. Media outlets played a divided role, with independent channels amplifying protest realities while state-aligned media minimized dissent. YouTubers and bloggers, despite limited formal power, significantly influenced public perception through digital platforms. Finally, international organizations and NGOs applied external pressure by condemning human rights violations, reinforcing the legitimacy of the movement and increasing global scrutiny of state actions.

Opposition Parties (BNP, Jamaat-e-Islami, etc.)

The Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and Jamaat-e-Islami were indirectly involved in the July Uprising following prolonged political repression under the Awami League government. Over the previous 16 years, party leaders and activists—particularly from Jamaat-e-Islami—were subjected to arrests, trials, executions, and systematic suppression, which fostered long-term resentment and organizational resilience.During the uprising, experienced activists from both parties contributed to sustaining mobilization, largely at the grassroots level. Individuals associated with Islami Chhatra Shibir were involved in coordination and organizational support behind the scenes. BNP maintained a strategic distance by allowing student groups to lead publicly, thereby reducing the risk of intensified state repression and preserving the movement's legitimacy.

Although the uprising appeared student-led, the background support, experience, and strategic restraint of BNP and Jamaat-e-Islami played a significant role in maintaining momentum and continuity

Power and Interest Rating of the Key Actors

The actor analysis *(figure: 2)* provides a quantitative framework for understanding how these actors influenced the events surrounding the protests. This analysis can offer valuable insights into the dynamics of the uprising and highlight the gaps in engagement among different parties involved in the struggle for justice and democratic governance

Figure 2

Actor Mean Power and Mean Interest Rating

The power–interest analysis (Figure 2) illustrates variations in influence and engagement among key actors during the July Uprising. The Awami League government displayed relatively high power (3.10) but low interest (2.41), indicating limited responsiveness to public and student demands. Violent repression and dismissive rhetoric reflected this disengagement and contributed to protest escalation.In contrast, the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement demonstrated the highest levels of power (4.31) and interest (4.62), reflecting strong mobilization capacity, nationwide coordination, and sustained commitment. The general public also showed high power (3.90) and interest (4.28), particularly as state violence intensified and the movement evolved into a broader struggle for democratic rights.Media actors recorded moderately high power (3.52) and interest (3.79), though their influence was constrained by censorship and intimidation. YouTubers and bloggers exhibited moderate power (2.86) and interest (3.38), primarily through online narrative framing. The international community and NGOs demonstrated relatively high power (3.79) and interest (3.90), as external pressure and human rights advocacy intensified.Opposition political parties showed moderate power (2.93) and interest (3.55), reflecting indirect and strategic involvement. Law enforcement agencies exhibited moderate power (2.88) and low interest (3.00), with their role focused on enforcement rather than engagement. A negative correlation between the power of law enforcement agencies and student protestors ($r = -0.25$) highlights the adversarial relationship between the state and the movement.

Clustering the Actors and Their Actions in July Uprising

The July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh was a significant moment in the country‘s political landscape, marked by various actors whose ideologies and actions either supported or opposed the movement. The dynamics among these actors highlight the complexities and tensions inherent in the struggle for democratic rights and social justice. On one side, the Awami League Government, its student wing (the Student League), certain media outlets, law enforcement agencies, the Supreme Court, and university authorities were aligned against the protests, advocating for suppression. Conversely, the Anti-discrimination Students Movement, select Youtubers and bloggers, segments of the general public, supportive media, international organizations, opposition political parties, and the Bangladesh Army emerged as allies of the movement.

University teachers’ networks

The Awami League government was centrally positioned among actors opposing the uprising. The state response was characterized by dismissive rhetoric and coercive suppression, with law enforcement agencies deployed against student protests. Violent confrontations, particularly on July 16, resulted in injuries and fatalities and intensified public outrage. The Bangladesh Student League, as the ruling party’s student wing, was actively involved in countering student protestors, often through confrontational means. Law enforcement agencies, including the police and RAB, were primarily engaged in enforcing government directives, frequently through force rather than dialogue. Reports of violence against protestors and journalists further reflected an increasingly repressive environment.Institutional actors such as the Supreme Court and university authorities were also perceived as aligned against the movement. The Supreme Court’s decision to reinstate the quota system acted as a key trigger for protests and was widely interpreted as reinforcing state authority over merit-based concerns. University authorities were criticized for failing to protect students and for their limited engagement during episodes of violence on campuses.In contrast, the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement emerged as the core pro-uprising actor, leading mobilization and sustaining protests nationwide. The movement expanded rapidly following violent crackdowns and student deaths, transforming initial quota-related demands into broader calls for accountability. Support from segments of the general public increased as repression intensified, reflecting shared grievances regarding governance and democratic rights. Select YouTubers and bloggers played a supportive role by disseminating information and shaping public narratives, while supportive media outlets amplified protest-related coverage.International organizations and NGOs contributed by condemning state violence and highlighting human rights concerns, thereby increasing external pressure on the government. Opposition political parties remained largely in the background but were positioned as supportive stakeholders. Notably, the Bangladesh Army, initially neutral, was increasingly perceived as sympathetic to public sentiment in the later stages of the uprising.Overall, the clustering reveals a clear division between state-aligned institutions seeking to suppress dissent and a broad coalition of students, citizens, and supportive actors advocating for reform, accountability, and democratic rights.

Discussion

This study was conducted to analyze the factors, key actors, and interrelationships that shaped the July Uprising of 2024 in Bangladesh, with particular focus on the correlation between actors’ power and interest. Eleven key stakeholders were identified, including state institutions,

student groups, media, political actors, civil society, and international organizations.High levels of power and interest were observed among the Anti-Discrimination Students Movement and the general public, enabling sustained mobilization and broad societal support. In contrast, the Awami League government and university authorities retained considerable institutional power but demonstrated limited interest in addressing protest demands, indicating a clear institutional–public disconnect. The Bangladesh Student League was aligned with the government, while the media landscape remained divided between state-aligned and independent reporting. External pressure was applied by international organizations and NGOs, while opposition political parties remained supportive but largely indirect. Law enforcement agencies were primarily engaged in enforcing state directives, and judicial actions by the Supreme Court became key points of contention.Correlation analysis indicated a positive relationship between public and student protestors' interests ($r = 0.44$), reflecting strong societal alignment. A moderate correlation between media power and government authority ($r = 0.25$) suggested state influence over information flows, while a negative correlation between law enforcement power and student protestors ($r = -0.25$) highlighted the adversarial impact of state repression on grassroots mobilization.Overall, the findings were found to be consistent with social movement and state repression theories, while also demonstrating how local political dynamics shaped the trajectory of the July Uprising in Bangladesh.

Conclusion

The July Uprising of 2024 is widely regarded as a defining moment in Bangladesh's pursuit of democracy, accountability, and social justice. Through an actor–factor matrix analysis, eleven key actors were identified, revealing varied levels of power and interest and highlighting complex interactions among state institutions, student movements, the public, media, and international actors. Although the uprising was initially triggered by quota-related grievances, it evolved into a broader resistance against authoritarian practices and democratic erosion as public support intensified.The findings emphasize the necessity of constructive political engagement during crises. Repression was shown to exacerbate conflict, whereas dialogue, transparency, and responsiveness were identified as essential for addressing grievances and restoring public trust. The importance of inclusive governance, institutional accountability, and independent oversight—particularly regarding law enforcement conduct—was underscored.Overall, while the July Uprising reflected deep-rooted societal discontent, it also presented an opportunity for democratic renewal. By fostering inclusive participation, protecting civic space, and respecting diverse viewpoints, a more accountable and responsive governance framework may be advanced in Bangladesh.

References

Aljazeera. (2024, July 28). Bangladesh restores mobile internet after 11-day blackout to quell protests. https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2024/7/28/bangladesh- restores-mobile-internet-after-11-day-blackout-to-quell-protests

Almond, K. (2019, April). This photographer spent 107 days in jail. But he won't be silenced. *CNN*. https://edition.cnn.com/interactive/2019/04/world/shahidul-alam- cnnphotos/

Bryman, A. (2012). *Social research methods* (4th ed.). Oxford University Press.

Chowdhury, S. R. H. (2024). The role of political parties in Bangladesh's July revolution of 2024: Insights from Sufi perspectives. *International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science (IJRISS)*. https://dx.doi.org/10.47772/IJRISS.2024.8110166

Chugtai, A., & Ali, M. (2024, August 7). How Bangladesh's _Gen Z' protests brought down

Corea, H., & Erum, N. (2024). What is happening at the quota-reform protests in Bangladesh? *Amnesty International*. https://www.amnesty.org/en/latest/news/2024/07/what-is-happening-at-the-quota- reform-protests-in-bangladesh/

Creswell, J. W., & Plano Clark, V. L. (2011). *Designing and conducting mixed methods research*. SAGE.

Davenport, C. (2007). State repression and the domestic democratic peace. In

Cambridge University Press, 36–50. https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511510021

Finnemore, M., & Sikkink, K. (1998). International norm dynamics and political change. *International Organization*, *52*(4), 887–917. [invalid URL removed]

Frooman, J. (1999). Stakeholder influence strategies.

The Academy of Management Review, *24*(2), 191–205. https://doi.org/10.2307/259074Ganguly, S. (2024, July 18). Explainer: Why are Bangladesh students titute protesting against job quotas? *Reuters*. https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/why-are-bangladesh-students-protesting- against-job-quotas-2024-07-18/

Gupta, R. (2024). *Political turmoil in Bangladesh: Hasina's fall, the rise of an interim government, and regional dynamics*. Asia Society Policy Ins